

Weekly Economic Commentary 13 Jul 2026

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 By [Westpac New Zealand Economics](#)

08:27 July 13 2026

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Analysis and forecasts of the economy and markets, along with previews of data for the week ahead.



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From nail-biter to head-scratcher.

The RBNZ kicked off a new tightening cycle last week, raising the OCR by 25bps to 2.50%. That went against our expectation of an ‘on hold’ decision, but analyst opinion was split going into the meeting and market pricing strongly favoured a hike. So the decision itself wasn’t out of left field, but some of the reasoning behind it left us scratching our heads a bit. Ultimately, though, it amounted to a difference of opinion about timing rather than the direction of policy, and we’ve adjusted our OCR forecast track only by as much as needed.

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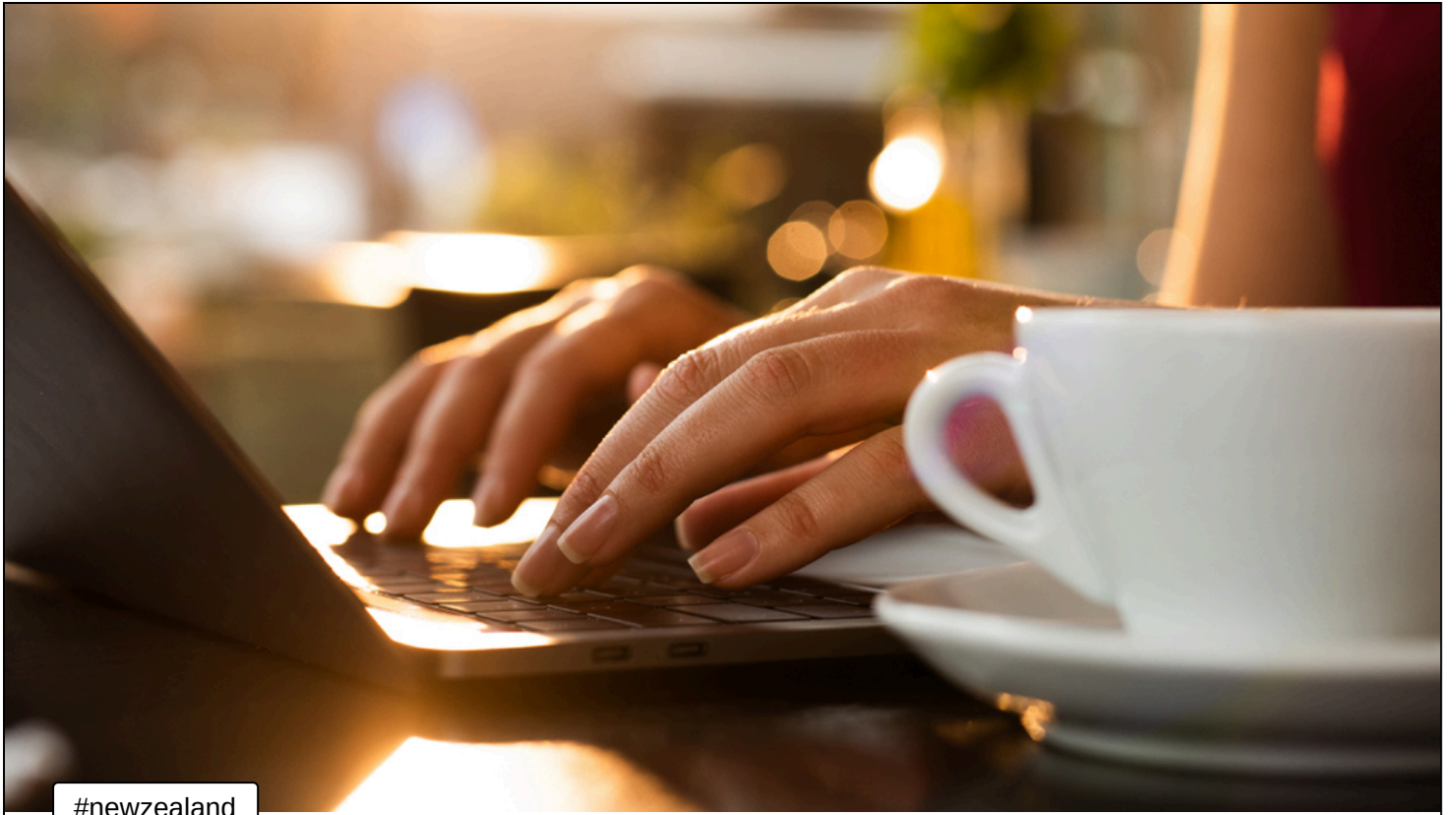


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